Grievance Desk

A secure, RBI-ready complaints desk for India's smaller banks, with an AI complaint assistant and AI routing and escalation

Strategy, Product Marketing and Execution Plan

Course	Product Management with AI, IIM Calcutta (Prof. Saravana Jaikumar)
Assignment	Capstone Project: Strategize, Build and Go-to-Market (deliverable 3 of 4)
Product	Grievance Desk, demo instance "Sangam Bank", built with Claude Code on Supabase (Postgres, Mumbai region) and GitHub Pages. Live: https://connect2soniasuresh-ui.github.io/MyComplaintsSystem/ Reviewer demo, no login: add `?demo` to the address
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Companion deliverables: **Consumer and Segment Analysis** (full research and personas), **Presentation deck**, and the **working product** with its CLAUDE.md in the project folder.

1. Executive Summary

Grievance Desk is a white-label complaints website and staff console for India's smaller banks. A customer lodges a complaint about any banking service, by form or by chatting with an AI assistant, gets a reference number straight away and tracks it. The bank's complaints officers work one shared queue in which every case runs on two clocks: the bank's own **24-hour resolution target**, and RBI's rule that a bank must give its final reply within **30 days** before the customer can go to the RBI Ombudsman. AI routes each case to the right team, and an escalation matrix raises it automatically within hours, long before Day 30. A monthly report gives the nodal officer the numbers the board and RBI ask for.

13.34 lakh	**~600**	**56%**	**₹3.6 lakh/yr**
complaints to the RBI Ombudsman in FY2024-25, up 13.6% in a year	Tier 2 and 3 urban cooperative banks in our beachhead	of bank fraud cases are card and internet fraud	target price for a 25-branch bank, below one clerk's cost

Why we win: it is built around RBI's grievance rules, not adapted from a generic helpdesk. It is **safe by design**: OTPs, PINs, card numbers, Aadhaar and PAN are refused in the browser and again in the database. Fraud goes first. Every look at customer data is logged. Data stays in India. There is nothing to install, so a bank can go live in under two weeks.

> **Strategy in one line:** Give a smaller bank a complaints desk it can trust and launch in under two weeks. It lets customers complain just by chatting, uses AI to route every case to the right team and resolve it within 24 hours, never past RBI's 30 days, keeps customers' secrets out of the system, and hands the nodal officer a board-ready report every month.

Beachhead: Tier 2 and 3 urban cooperative banks (5 to 60 branches) in Maharashtra and Gujarat, then small finance banks and the 28 merged regional rural banks. **GTM motion:** account-based, founder-led sales through cooperative-bank federations, core-banking vendors and auditors, backed by a free 60-day pilot. **Business model:** annual SaaS subscription by bank size, plus a setup fee. **Launch:** week of **18 January 2027**, with 3 pilot banks live and 2 paying banks (₹6 lakh+ ARR) by 31 March 2027.

What we built for the capstone: a complete, working product covering three core flows end to end (lodge, track, staff resolution), with two AI features. New since Mini Project 3: a **monthly MIS report** with CSV and PDF export, a **reviewer demo mode**, and project documentation in **CLAUDE.md**.

2. Strategy and Opportunity

2.1 The problem

India's smaller banks face the same complaint rules as the largest banks: a named nodal officer, a final reply within 30 days, escalation to the RBI Ombudsman, and growing data-protection duties. But they run complaints on **branch registers, a shared mailbox and an Excel sheet**. Nobody has a live view of which cases are close to Day 30. Fraud complaints wait in the same pile as cheque-book requests. Customers email OTPs and Aadhaar copies. At inspection time, staff rebuild the history by hand. The nodal officer, who is personally accountable, finds out a case is late only when it has already escalated.

Pain today	Consequence	How Grievance Desk fixes it
Complaints arrive on paper registers at branches, a shared mailbox, phone calls and walk-ins	No single list. Cases get lost and nobody knows how many are open.	One online form, used by customers and by branch staff for walk-ins, and one shared queue
No running clock	Breaches are discovered only after the customer escalates	A 24-hour clock on every case (then Day X of 30); auto-escalation at 4, 12 and 20 hours
Customers email OTPs, card numbers and Aadhaar copies	Data-protection risk and a target for fraudsters	Confidential-data guard in the browser and the database; no uploads
Fraud complaints wait in the general pile	Customers miss the 3-day zero-liability window; losses and anger grow	Automatic urgent flag, Fraud cell routing, block-first guidance
“Where is my complaint?” calls	Branch and call-centre time wasted	Self-service tracking with reference number and mobile
Board and RBI reports built by hand	An evening a month in Excel; numbers hard to verify	Monthly report with CSV and PDF export
No audit trail at inspection time	Days spent rebuilding history from emails and registers	Timestamped history and logged contact reveals

2.2 Why now

- **Complaints are rising fast.** The RBI Integrated Ombudsman Scheme received **13,34,244 complaints in FY2024-25, up 13.55%** from 11,75,075, and the disposal rate slipped from 95.1% to 93.1%. Loans (29.3%), credit cards (17.2%), mobile and electronic banking (16.9%) and deposit accounts (16.8%) lead. All four are in our service list.
- **Consolidation and tighter supervision.** The number of UCBs fell to **1,457** by March 2025, with 7 mergers and 8 licence cancellations in the year, under a four-tier regulatory framework. RRBs were merged from 43 into **28** on 1 May 2025. Survivors must show they are well run.
- **Small UCB customers have no RBI fallback.** The Ombudsman scheme covers UCBs only above ₹50 crore in deposits, so for many cooperative-bank customers, the bank's own desk is the only formal route.
- **Digital fraud.** Card and internet fraud made up **13,516 of 23,953** bank fraud cases in FY2024-25. Victims must report within 3 working days for zero liability, so fraud complaints must be found and acted on the same day.
- **DPDP Act, 2023.** Data minimisation, purpose-limited consent and access logging are becoming legal duties. Our product already does all three.

- **AI makes it affordable.** An AI assistant can turn a customer's own words, in their own language, into a complete complaint, and AI-assisted development let a small team build a security-hardened product in weeks. That is what makes a price smaller banks can approve possible.

2.3 Market opportunity (India, top-down)

Layer	Definition	Estimate
TAM	All RBI-regulated banks and lenders with a customer grievance function: commercial banks, SFBs, payments banks, RRBs, UCBs, state and district cooperative banks, NBFCs	~12,000 entities
SAM	Smaller banks with no enterprise CRM: 1,457 UCBs, ~11 SFBs, 28 RRBs, ~6 payments banks, and ~350 state and district cooperative banks	~1,850 banks × average ₹3.5 lakh ACV ≈ **₹65 Cr/yr**
Beachhead	Tier 2 and 3 UCBs, 5 to 60 branches	~600 banks ≈ **₹21 Cr/yr**
SOM (3 years)	Reachable through federations and core-banking vendor partners	100 to 150 banks ≈ **₹4 to 5 Cr ARR**

Bank counts: RBI Trend and Progress 2024-25 and Ministry of Finance; others approximate. NBFCs (~9,000) are a Year 2 adjacency.

2.4 Strategic choices

Choice	What we decided	Why
Where to play	Smaller RBI-regulated banks, starting with Tier 2 and 3 UCBs in Maharashtra and Gujarat	Highest pain for the size of the team, best product fit, reachable through federations
How to win	Compliance-native and safe by design, fast and cheap to launch, AI where it removes effort	Generic helpdesks lack the RBI rules; enterprise suites are too costly and slow
What we will not do	Chase large banks; build integrations before demand; let AI decide without a human; collect documents or full account numbers	Focus, speed and trust
Moat over time	Federation partnerships and peer references; routing models tuned on cooperative-bank complaints; the board-report standard banks adopt	Cooperative bankers buy what peers use; switching costs rise once the desk is in the bank's grievance policy

3. Target Segments and Primary Persona

> This is a summary. The full evidence, segment scoring, end-user segments, supporting personas, journey maps and validation plan are in our separate deliverable, **Consumer and Segment Analysis**.

3.1 Segmentation and choice of beachhead

Segment	Pain	Ability to pay	Sales cycle	Fit with product	Decision
Large public and private banks	High	High	12–18 months	Low (in-house CRM)	Not targeted
Urban cooperative banks, Tier 2 and 3 (~600)	**Very high** (tight supervision, tiny IT teams, paper registers)	Low–medium	2–4 months, board approval	**Very high** (lockers, cheques, deposits, branch service all covered)	**Beachhead**
Small finance banks (~11) and RRBs (28)	High (fast-growing digital volume, rural customers)	Medium	3–6 months	High	**Beachhead (second wave)**
Payments banks, fintechs	High volume of UPI complaints	Medium–high	1–3 months	Medium (fewer services)	Opportunistic
NBFCs and digital lenders	High	Medium	2–4 months	Medium (loan-focused service list)	Year 2

> **Target segment:** RBI-regulated **urban cooperative banks** with roughly 5 to 60 branches, then **small finance banks and RRBs**. These banks receive about 5 to 150 complaints a day, have 1 to 10 people handling complaints, rely on a core-banking vendor rather than an in-house IT team, and today track complaints on paper, email or Excel.

3.2 Primary persona: the champion and daily owner

Rajesh Kulkarni, 46, Principal Nodal Officer and Head of Customer Service
A Tier-3 urban cooperative bank in Pune with 28 branches, 3.5 lakh customers, about 40 complaints a day and 4 people handling them.

Background: joined as a clerk 22 years ago and rose through branch operations. Comfortable with the core-banking system and Excel, cautious with new tech. Named as nodal officer on the bank's website, so RBI escalations land on his desk personally. Reports to the CEO and presents to the board's Customer Service Committee every quarter.

A typical day: collects complaint registers scanned by branches, reads the complaints mailbox, phones branch managers for updates, keeps a master Excel

Goals

- No complaint goes past 30 days and nothing reaches the RBI Ombudsman
- Pass the next RBI inspection without scrambling
- Look modern and in control to the board
- Protect customers from fraud and their own oversharing

Frustrations

- "I find out a complaint is late when the customer calls the CEO."
- "Customers email me their OTP and Aadhaar. That's a liability I don't want."
- "The board report takes me a whole evening every month."

sheet, and once a month works late putting the board report together.

- "Our IT vendor quotes six months for anything new."

Buying criteria: simple enough for branch staff, data in India, nothing to install, cost a board will approve, recommended by peers or the federation.

Where he gets information: his state UCB federation and the national federation (NAFCUB), RBI circulars, WhatsApp groups of cooperative-bank officers, the Banking Frontiers and cooperative-sector press, his core-banking vendor's user meets, statutory and concurrent auditors, and annual sector conferences.

3.3 Buying committee

Role	Cares about	What wins them
CEO / General Manager (economic buyer)	RBI standing, reputation, cost, board optics	Past-24-hour and Past-30-days tiles at zero, Escalated tile and escalation log, peer references, low annual fee
Board Customer Service Committee	Oversight, fewer escalations	Monthly report (built): received, resolved, % within 24 hours and 30 days, by service and team; automatic escalation log showing every case escalated within hours
Compliance officer / Internal auditor	Evidence, data protection, DPDP	Audit trail, contact-access log, confidential-data guard, consent capture
IT head / core-banking vendor	No integration work, security	Hosted, nothing to install, India region, row-level security, CSP, staff by invitation only
Complaints officers (daily users)	Simplicity, not being blamed	One queue, urgent and oldest first, history in one place
Bank customers (end users)	Being heard, safety, knowing the status	2-minute form, instant reference number, tracking, clear Ombudsman rights

3.4 Jobs-to-be-done

- **Functional:** "Capture every complaint, resolve it within 30 days, and prove that we did."
- **Reporting:** "At month end, give me the numbers the board and RBI ask for without a night in Excel."
- **Risk:** "Stop customer secrets from coming into our systems, and catch fraud cases first."
- **Emotional / social:** "Let me face the board and RBI inspectors with confidence, and let customers trust us."

4. The Product

4.1 Core user flows (all working end to end)

Flow	Steps	User
1. Lodge	Pick a service and issue, or describe the problem in a chat → the AI fills in the form → the customer checks it, adds name and mobile, ticks consent → submit → reference number and reply-by date. Any OTP, PIN, card number, Aadhaar or PAN is flagged and blocked.	Bank customer, or branch staff for walk-ins
2. Track	Reference number + registered mobile → status, timeline and history → reply if the bank asks for information → RBI Ombudsman route shown after Day 30 or if the customer disagrees.	Bank customer
3. Resolve	Officer signs in → queue sorted urgent, escalated and oldest first → open a case → see routing, AI risk and history → reveal contact details (logged) → re-route if needed → send an update or resolve.	Complaints officer, team lead
4. Report New	Staff tab → Monthly report → choose a month → read received, resolved, % within 24 hours and 30 days, average time, by service and team → download CSV or print to PDF.	Principal Nodal Officer, CEO, board

> **Two clocks.** Each bank sets its own **24-hour resolution target**. It drives the case clock, the meter and the time-based escalations (no action for 4 hours → team lead; 12 hours open → Principal Nodal Officer; 20 hours → Internal Ombudsman or GM). RBI's **30-day** final-reply deadline stays as the outer limit on the customer's receipt and triggers the Ombudsman route. Aiming at 24 hours means a case reaches Day 30 only if several people have ignored it.

4.2 What the product does today

Capability	What it does (as built)	Who benefits
Guided 4-step complaint form	Covers **12 banking services** (accounts, debit cards and ATMs, credit cards, UPI/NEFT/IMPS/RTGS, internet and mobile banking, loans, deposits, cheques, branch service, insurance and investments, lockers, KYC) and **about 50 specific issue types**. Captures transaction date, amount, UTR/RRN and the outcome the customer wants. Works on mobile.	Customer
Instant reference number	Reference numbers like `GD-261004-K7QZ8M2P` have 8 random characters so they can't be guessed. The receipt shows the 24-hour resolution target and the Day 30 final-reply date; the timeline then shows the RBI Ombudsman route.	Customer
Track and reply	Customers prove it's theirs with reference number plus registered mobile. Tracking locks for an hour after 5 wrong attempts. When the bank asks for more information (status "Waiting for you"), the customer replies on the same page.	Customer, call centre
Fraud triage	Unauthorised transactions, money sent to the wrong account and phishing are flagged **urgent** automatically and moved to the top of the queue. The customer is told to block the card first and report within 3 working days (RBI's zero-liability window).	Customer, bank risk team

Confidential-data guard	Blocks OTP, CVV, PIN, passwords, full card numbers (Luhn-checked), Aadhaar, PAN and full account numbers, **in the browser and again in the database**. Staff messages that *ask* for these are blocked too, which stops phishing-style requests. No file uploads.	Customer, Compliance, CISO
Staff queue and two clocks	Shared queue with tiles for Open, Urgent and open, Escalated, Past 24-hour target, Past 30 days, and Resolved this month. Each case shows a progress bar against the 24-hour target ("6h of 24h"), then "Past 24h · Day 3 of 30". Search by reference or name, filter by status, service and team. Each row shows the case's team and escalation level. Urgent, escalated and oldest cases first.	Complaints officers, Head of grievance
Audit trail and privacy controls	Every status change and message is timestamped with the officer's identity. Staff see mobile and email masked; revealing them is a deliberate click logged with who and when. Staff sign-in only by invitation, with sign-out after 15 minutes of inactivity.	Compliance, Internal audit
Built-in RBI transparency	After 30 days, or when the bank closes a complaint the customer disagrees with, the tracker shows the RBI Ombudsman escalation route (cms.rbi.org.in, 14448).	Customer, Compliance
India data residency, low running cost	Static website plus hosted Postgres in the Mumbai region, with row-level security and no direct table access. Running costs are very low, and there's a demo mode for sales demos.	CTO, CFO
AI Complaint Assistant (Section 4.3)	"Describe it in a chat" on the Lodge tab. The AI asks follow-up questions and fills in the form; the customer checks it, adds name and mobile, and submits.	Customer
AI routing and auto-escalation (Section 4.3)	Rules route every complaint to one of nine teams the moment it's lodged; AI then re-routes it once, rates its risk and flags hidden fraud. An escalation matrix raises cases to Team lead, Principal Nodal Officer or Internal Ombudsman / GM. Staff can re-route; every step is logged with its reason and hidden from the customer.	Complaints officers, Nodal officer, Compliance
New **Monthly report**	Staff click "Monthly report" to see any month: complaints received and resolved, share resolved within 24 hours and within 30 days, average time to resolve, open cases and cases past 24 hours and past 30 days, by service and by team. **Download CSV** (contacts masked, formula-safe) or **print to PDF** for the board's Customer Service Committee and RBI returns.	Nodal officer, CEO, Board
New **Reviewer and sales demo mode**	Add `?demo` to the live address to walk through every screen, including the staff console, with 9 sample complaints that show every escalation rule. Nothing is saved.	Reviewers, prospects, sales

4.3 Where AI fits

Built with AI: the product was designed and coded with Claude Code on Supabase (hosted Postgres) and GitHub Pages. That's why a small team could build a production-grade, security-hardened app in weeks, and that speed is part of our cost advantage. **AI in the product** comes from two features, both built into the prototype. They run in a server-side function that calls Claude (Anthropic), so the API key never reaches the browser. Live demo: https://connect2soniasuresh-ui.github.io/MyComplaintsSystem/

AI feature	What it does	Why it matters

Built **1. AI Complaint Assistant (chatbot)**	The customer types the problem in their own words, for example "I paid ₹2,500 by UPI on 2 Oct, money left my account but the shop didn't get it". The assistant identifies the service and issue (UPI, debit-but-not-credited), pulls out the date, amount and UTR, asks only for what's missing, and shows a summary. One click fills in the complaint form; the customer checks it, adds their name and mobile, and submits it to get a reference number. It replies in the customer's language (English, Hindi or another Indian language) and fills in the form in English. Every message goes through the existing confidential-data guard, so if the customer types an OTP or PIN the assistant refuses it and explains why. It will never ask for one.	Removes the hardest part of complaining (choosing among 12 services and about 50 issues), so customers drop off less and complaints are complete. This matters for rural and less tech-savvy customers.
Built **2. AI routing and auto-escalation**	**Routing:** AI reads each complaint and sends it to one of nine teams (Cards & ATMs, Payments & UPI, Digital banking, Loans & recovery, Accounts & deposits, Branch operations, Insurance & investments, KYC & records, Fraud cell), using the service, the issue, the amount and the wording, and rates its risk as low, medium or high. It also catches likely fraud the customer filed under the wrong category. **Escalation:** a rule-based matrix, informed by the AI risk rating, escalates cases automatically. A fraud case, or one the AI rates high risk, goes to the team lead straight away, and fraud of ₹1 lakh or more goes to the Principal Nodal Officer. A case with no action for 4 hours goes to the team lead. A case open 12 hours against the 24-hour target goes to the Principal Nodal Officer, and at 20 hours to the Internal Ombudsman or GM. A customer's third complaint in 90 days goes to the Principal Nodal Officer. Levels never go down. Every routing and escalation is logged in the case history with the reason.	Complaints reach the right officer in minutes, not days. Cases are escalated within hours, so breaches of the 30-day limit are prevented long before they happen, and the escalation chain RBI expects is followed automatically and recorded.

Safeguards (as built): the chatbot never sees the customer's name, mobile or email, because the customer types those into the form; messages containing an OTP, PIN, CVV, card, Aadhaar or PAN number are blocked before they reach the model; the AI routes each complaint only once and staff can re-route; rule-based routing and fraud flags apply even if the AI is unavailable; each user is rate-limited; every AI decision is recorded in the audit trail. Later roadmap: a weekly AI insight brief for the board and AI-drafted replies for officers.

4.4 How it is built

Layer	Choice	Why
Front end	Plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript on GitHub Pages; mobile-first; light and dark themes; strict Content Security Policy	Nothing to install; fast on low-end phones; cheap to host per bank
Database and access	Supabase Postgres in Mumbai; row-level security on with no policies; all access through checked `security definer` functions	Data stays in India; the browser can never read tables directly
AI	Supabase Edge Function calling Claude for the chat assistant and routing; API key held server-side; rate-limited	Customers' contact details never reach the AI; rules still work if AI is down
Escalations	Rule matrix in the database, run every 30 minutes by `pg_cron`	Escalations happen even if nobody opens the queue

Development	Built with Claude Code (and Cursor); the project's conventions and safety rules are recorded in `CLAUDE.md`	A small team shipped a security-hardened product in weeks

4.5 Scope: what we built, and what we deliberately left out

In scope and working: the four flows above, both AI features, the confidential-data guard, routing and escalation, audit logging, the monthly report and the reviewer demo mode. **Deliberately out of scope for now:** SMS and email notifications, regional-language forms (the chat already answers in the customer's language), CAPTCHA and staff MFA (both available in Supabase, to switch on per bank), and core-banking integration. These are on the pilot build plan (Section 9), so the product stays focused on the core flows our persona needs most.

5. Value Proposition and Positioning

5.1 Core value proposition

> *"Every complaint resolved within 24 hours, never past RBI's 30 days. Customers' secrets never stored. Live in under two weeks."*
>
> Grievance Desk gives smaller banks a branded, secure complaints website and staff queue built around a 24-hour resolution target, well inside RBI's 30-day rule. Customers get a reference number at once and can track their complaint. Fraud cases go to the top of the queue, confidential details are blocked before they are stored, and every staff action is logged. An AI Complaint Assistant lets customers complain just by chatting, and AI routing sends every case to the right team and escalates it automatically within hours.

5.2 Value proposition canvas

Customer jobs	Pains	Gains wanted
Record every complaint; reply within 30 days; protect customer data; report to the board and RBI; spot fraud fast	Paper and email; breaches discovered late; OTP and Aadhaar arriving in inboxes; no audit trail; slow IT vendors; personal accountability	Zero Ombudsman escalations; a clean inspection; fewer follow-up calls; a modern image; quick launch at low cost
Products and services	**Pain relievers**	**Gain creators**
12-service guided form; reference number and tracking; staff queue with 24-hour and 30-day clocks; fraud auto-flag; confidential-data guard; audit and access logs; **Built** AI Complaint Assistant (chatbot), AI routing and auto-escalation	One queue; Past 24-hour and Past 30 days alarm tiles; secrets refused in the browser and the database; masked contacts; timestamped history; nothing to install	Customers check status themselves; Ombudsman rights shown openly (builds trust); every AI routing decision comes with a plain-language reason; branded for the bank

5.3 Competitive alternatives

Alternative	Strengths	Gaps for our persona
Paper register + email + Excel (status quo)	Free, familiar	No clock, no tracking, no audit trail, secrets end up in inboxes
Complaint module from the core-banking vendor	Already a supplier	Usually an internal-only form, no customer tracking, few privacy controls, slow change requests
Generic helpdesk (e.g. Freshdesk, Zoho Desk)	Cheap, mature	Not built for banking: no 30-day RBI clock, no Ombudsman flow, accepts any attachment or text including OTPs and Aadhaar, needs configuration skills
Enterprise CX suites (e.g. Salesforce, Sprinklr)	Powerful	Priced and scoped for large banks, long implementation projects
RBI CMS portal	Free, official	It's where escalations end up, which is exactly what banks want to avoid. It doesn't replace the bank's own desk.

5.4 Positioning map

	Generic / low banking fit	Built for Indian banking compliance

Fast, affordable, nothing to install	Excel, email, generic helpdesks	**Grievance Desk (open space we target)**
Slow, expensive, IT-heavy	Horizontal CRM	Enterprise CX suites, core-banking add-ons

5.5 Positioning statement

> **For** nodal officers and CEOs of India's cooperative, small finance and regional rural banks
> **who** must resolve every customer complaint within RBI's 30-day window without the budget or IT team of a large bank,
> **Grievance Desk is** a secure, branded online complaints desk with an AI complaint chatbot and AI-powered routing and escalation
> **that** lets customers lodge a complaint just by chatting, gives them a reference number and live tracking, routes every case to the right team, escalates it automatically within hours against a 24-hour target, flags fraud first and blocks confidential details before they are stored.
> **Unlike** paper registers, generic helpdesks or core-banking add-ons,
> **Grievance Desk** is built around RBI's grievance rules and Indian data-protection law, has nothing to install, and can go live in under two weeks.

5.6 Points of difference and reasons to believe

Point of difference	Reason to believe (in the product today)
Faster than the rule: 24 hours, not 30 days	A 24-hour clock on every case, escalations at 4, 12 and 20 hours, Past 24-hour and Past 30 days alarm tiles, the 24-hour target and Day 30 date on the customer's receipt, and the Ombudsman route shown after Day 30
Safe by design	Confidential details blocked in the browser and again in the database; staff requests for secrets blocked; no uploads; only the last 4 digits of account and card numbers collected
Fraud first	Fraud issue types flagged urgent automatically and shown first; block-first and 3-day zero-liability guidance shown to the customer
Ready for audit	Timestamped event history per case; every reveal of a customer's contact details logged; staff accounts by invitation only, with 15-minute idle sign-out; a monthly report ready for the board and RBI returns
Data stays in India and it's cheap to run	Mumbai-region database, static hosting, about ₹2–5k/month infrastructure per bank, so we can price for cooperative banks
Speed	A working, security-hardened product was built quickly with AI-assisted development. Launching a new bank means branding plus adding staff accounts.

Product gaps to close for launch (presented as roadmap, never claimed today): SMS and email notifications; Hindi and regional-language forms; CAPTCHA; MFA for staff; a published retention policy. The MIS/CSV export listed in Mini Project 3 is now built (the monthly report).

6. Key Messaging and Communication Approach

6.1 Message house

> **Umbrella message:** "The complaints desk your customers can trust and RBI can inspect."

Pillar 1: Never miss Day 30	Pillar 2: Safe by design	Pillar 3: AI does the legwork
Every complaint gets a reference number and a visible 24-hour clock, with RBI's 30 days as the outer limit. Fraud goes first. Nothing slips through.	OTPs, PINs, CVVs, card numbers, Aadhaar and PAN are refused before they are stored. Every look at customer data is logged.	Customers complain just by chatting. AI routes each case to the right officer and escalates it within hours. No case sits forgotten.
Proof: 24-hour clock, Past 30 days tile, urgent-first queue	*Proof:* two-layer confidential-data guard, masked contacts, access log, India hosting	*Proof:* **Built** the chatbot turns a few sentences into a filled-in complaint form; every routing and escalation is logged with its reason

6.2 Messages by persona

Audience	Key message	Call to action
Nodal officer (Rajesh)	"Stop finding out about late complaints from RBI. Every case on a 24-hour clock, on one screen."	Watch the 3-minute demo; book a live demo with your branch list
CEO / GM	"A modern, branded complaints desk for less than the cost of one clerk, live before your next board meeting."	Ask for the 60-day pilot
Compliance / Auditor	"Every action is timestamped, every look at customer contact details is logged, and confidential details are blocked by the database itself."	Download the RBI and DPDP readiness checklist
IT head / core-banking vendor	"Nothing to install or integrate. A link on your website, data in Mumbai, and access rules enforced in the database."	Request the security note
Complaints officers	"One queue, urgent and oldest first, the full story of each case in one place. No more registers."	Try the demo-mode sandbox
Bank customers (bank-led message)	"Raise a complaint in 2 minutes, get a reference number instantly, and track it any time. We will never ask for your PIN or OTP."	"Lodge a complaint" button on the bank's website, passbook stickers, branch posters, SMS

6.3 Elevator pitch (30 seconds)

"RBI gives every bank 30 days to answer a complaint before the customer can go to the Ombudsman. Most cooperative and small banks still track complaints in paper registers and email, so they find out a case is late only when RBI forwards it, and their inboxes fill up with customers' OTPs and Aadhaar numbers. Grievance Desk gives them a branded online complaints desk. Customers get a reference number and live tracking, every case runs on a 24-hour resolution clock, fraud goes first, and confidential details are blocked before they are ever stored. Customers can simply chat with an AI assistant that fills in the form for them, and AI routes every case to the right team and escalates it within hours. It goes live in under two weeks, with nothing to install."

6.4 Communication approach

- **Tone:** calm, plain-language and trustworthy, like a senior compliance officer, not a tech startup. The product itself is written in simple English (“Tell us what went wrong”), and our marketing should sound the same.
- **Show it, don't describe it:** the strongest sales moment is typing an OTP into the form and watching it refuse. Build every demo, video and webinar around that moment and the 24-hour clock.
- **Trust through peers:** cooperative bankers buy what other cooperative bankers use. Federation endorsement and pilot-bank testimonials are the most important assets.
- **Responsible AI:** “AI assists, a human decides.” The chatbot runs through the same confidential-data guard and never asks for an OTP or PIN. Officers can override any AI routing decision. Every routing and escalation is logged with its reason, and customers' contact details never go to the AI.
- **Vernacular:** customer-facing collateral (posters, SMS) in Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, Tamil and other languages for each pilot bank's region.

7. Pricing and Business Model

7.1 Business model

B2B white-label SaaS, annual subscription paid by the bank, priced by **bank size (number of branches)** with a generous complaint allowance, plus a one-time setup fee. End customers never pay.

Why price by branches: cooperative-bank boards understand and budget by branch count. It is stable and predictable, which avoids the bank worrying that "more complaints means a bigger bill". It also tracks value, since more branches mean more complaints and more regulatory exposure. Per-user pricing would discourage banks from giving every officer and branch manager access.

7.2 Pricing rationale

- **Value created:** one complaints clerk costs a UCB about ₹4–5 lakh a year. Grievance Desk removes manual register and Excel work, cuts "where is my complaint" calls, and helps avoid Ombudsman escalations, compensation awards and adverse inspection findings. We estimate ₹6–10 lakh a year of value for a 25-branch bank.
- **What customers pay elsewhere:** generic helpdesks cost ₹1–3 lakh a year but need configuration and lack banking controls. Core-banking change requests and enterprise suites cost ₹10 lakh+.
- **Cost to serve:** static hosting and hosted Postgres cost roughly ₹2–5k a month per bank, plus AI API costs of under ₹1 per complaint. That allows **about 80% gross margin** at prices cooperative banks can approve.
- **Price point:** capture about 30–40% of the value, for an ROI of 3x or more and a price below the cost of one clerk.

7.3 Pricing tiers (indicative, ex-GST)

Tier	Essential	Professional (target tier)	Enterprise
Best for	Small UCBs, up to 10 branches	UCBs and RRBs with 11–60 branches	SFBs, larger UCBs, multi-state banks
Price	**₹12,000 / month** (₹1.44 lakh / yr)	**₹30,000 / month** (₹3.6 lakh / yr)	**From ₹9 lakh / yr**
Complaints included	1,000 / month	5,000 / month	Unlimited
Staff accounts	5	25	Unlimited
Included today	Branded complaints website, reference numbers and tracking, 12-service form, staff queue with 24-hour and 30-day clocks, fraud auto-flag, confidential-data guard, audit and access logs, monthly report with CSV export, India hosting		
Tier extras	Email support	+ AI Complaint Assistant (chatbot), AI routing and auto-escalation, SMS/email notifications	+ Custom escalation matrix (Internal Ombudsman, GM), board-report pack, weekly AI insight brief, custom domain, SSO and MFA, regional languages, dedicated success manager

Other revenue: setup fee of ₹25,000 (Essential) to ₹1.5 lakh (Enterprise) covering branding, staff onboarding, branch-staff training and customer-launch collateral. Add-ons such as WhatsApp intake, extra languages or an

IVR callback at ₹3,000–8,000 a month each.

Launch offers: (1) **60-day free pilot** for the first 5 banks in exchange for a testimonial and reference calls; (2) **Founding-bank price**, 25% off year 1 for contracts signed by 31 March 2027; (3) **Federation member rate**, 10% off for members of partner UCB federations.

7.4 Unit economics (Year 1 targets)

Metric	Target	Rationale
Average contract value (ACV)	₹3–4 lakh	Mostly Professional tier
Gross margin	~80%	Very low hosting cost; AI cost under ₹1 per complaint
CAC	≤ ₹1.2 lakh	Federation and vendor channels, founder-led sales
CAC payback	≤ 6 months	Annual billing in advance
Logo churn	< 8% / yr	Becomes part of the bank's grievance policy and customer communications
LTV : CAC	≥ 6 : 1	Low churn and tier upgrades

8. Go-to-Market Plan

8.1 GTM motion

Partner-assisted, account-based, founder-led sales. Cooperative banks rely on trusted intermediaries such as federations, core-banking vendors and auditors, so these are our main routes in. A free pilot removes the risk of buying, and pilot banks become the references that persuade the next ones.

8.2 Channel plan

Channel	Key activities	Purpose	KPI (to Mar 2027)
UCB federations (primary)	Approach state federations (start with Maharashtra and Gujarat, which have the most UCBs) and the national federation (NAFCUB). Offer a member rate and a free "30-day rule and DPDP" workshop for member banks.	Trust, reach	2 federation partnerships; 4 workshops
Core-banking and IT vendor partners	Referral and reseller deals with the software vendors that serve cooperative banks. Grievance Desk is a no-integration add-on they can offer. 20% revenue share.	Distribution	3 partners; 25% of pipeline
Auditors and compliance consultants	Concurrent and statutory audit firms that flag weak grievance processes. Referral fee of 15% of year-1 ACV.	Warm referrals	5 active referrers
Account-based outreach	List of 200 target banks from RBI lists, with nodal officers' names taken from each bank's website (they're required to publish them). Personalised email, LinkedIn and phone outreach, with a 3-minute demo video showing the OTP refusal and the 24-hour clock.	Pipeline	40 demos
Content and lead magnets	(1) "RBI 30-Day Rule and DPDP Readiness Checklist for Cooperative Banks"; (2) "What Customers Complain About: Insights from RBI Ombudsman Data"; (3) a free self-assessment: "Would your complaints desk pass an inspection?"	Lead generation	250 downloads; 60 qualified leads
Webinars and workshops	Monthly session with a guest (retired RBI or cooperative-bank official, or a DPDP lawyer), plus a live demo. Run in English and Marathi or Hindi.	Education	80 attendees per session
Events	Booth or speaking slot at cooperative-banking conferences and federation AGMs, and Global Fintech Fest for SFBs and payments banks. Closed-door breakfasts for nodal officers in Pune, Ahmedabad and Bengaluru.	Relationships	30 qualified conversations per event
LinkedIn and WhatsApp	Founder posts twice a week ("complaint of the week" teardowns, RBI rule explainers). Shareable 60-second demo clips designed to be forwarded in bankers' WhatsApp groups.	Awareness	150k impressions
PR and website	Launch story and pilot case study in banking and fintech media. Website with a demo-mode sandbox (already built), segment pages, pricing and security page. SEO for searches such as "complaint management system for cooperative bank" and "RBI 30 day complaint rule".	Credibility, inbound	4 media mentions; 1,500 visits/month

Bank-to-customer launch kit (for each customer bank)	Branch posters with QR codes, passbook inserts, SMS template, website banner and a "we never ask for your OTP" message, so the bank's own customers actually use the desk.	Adoption	≥ 60% of a pilot bank's complaints coming in online

8.3 Sales process

Stage	Activity	Exit criteria
1. Discovery (30 min)	Ask about current complaint channels, monthly volumes, recent RBI escalations, inspection findings and who signs off.	Pain confirmed; CEO's interest
2. Demo with the bank's own brand	A demo-mode instance branded with the bank's name and branches. Live OTP-refusal and fraud-flag moments.	Nodal officer wants a pilot
3. Security and compliance pack	Security note (row-level security, CSP, India region, access logs), data processing agreement, DPDP mapping.	IT and compliance sign-off
4. 60-day pilot	3 to 5 branches plus the head office desk. Success criteria agreed upfront (zero cases past 30 days, most cases resolved within 24 hours, share of complaints lodged online, officer time saved).	Criteria met
5. Board approval and contract	ROI one-pager and board note template written for the bank's board.	Board resolution, signed order
6. Roll out and expand	All branches go live with the customer launch kit. Quarterly review of routing accuracy and the escalation log.	All branches live in under 30 days; NPS ≥ 40

8.4 Launch sequence

Phase	Dates	Goal	Key activities
0. Validate	15 Oct to 8 Nov 2026	Confirm persona, value and price	Capstone product additions (monthly report, reviewer demo mode); 15 to 20 interviews with nodal officers and CEOs at UCBs, SFBs and RRBs; demo the live prototype; pricing survey; first conversations with federations
1. Pilot build and design partners	9 Nov to 20 Dec 2026	Launch-ready product, 3 pilot banks	Tune the AI Complaint Assistant and AI routing on pilot data; build SMS/email notifications, CAPTCHA and staff MFA; sign 3 pilot banks; set up branded instances
2. Pilots and pre-launch	21 Dec 2026 to 15 Jan 2027	Proof and assets	Pilots live with the customer launch kit; collect metrics; build website, demo video, checklist, sales deck, ROI one-pager and security pack; sign federation and vendor partners
3. Public launch	Week of 18 Jan 2027	Awareness and pipeline	Launch webinar co-hosted with a federation and a pilot-bank speaker; press release; founder launch post; ABM blitz to 200 banks; founding-bank offer opens
4. Convert and scale	Feb to Mar 2027	First revenue	Convert pilots to paid; federation workshops; first conference; 2 case studies; review the funnel and refine pricing and target segment

9. Execution Plan: Timeline, Milestones and Owners

Each activity has a role owner, and each role has a named Group 5 member, so every line in the plan has someone accountable.

Role	Responsibility	Owner(s)
PM	Product Manager and team lead; roadmap, pricing, go/no-go	Sonia
PMM	Positioning, messaging, content, website, launch campaign	Chetana (lead), Gayatri
GTM	Sales, account-based outreach, federation and vendor partnerships	Abhay (lead), Amir
TECH	Product codebase, Supabase, AI features, security pack	Sonia (lead), Padma Priya
CX	Pilot onboarding, training, customer launch kits, DPDP and RBI compliance	Urmila (lead), Padma Priya

9.1 Week-by-week plan (15 Oct 2026 to 31 Mar 2027)

Week / dates	Activities	Owner	Milestone
W1 · 15 to 18 Oct	Mini Project 3 submitted; assign roles; build a list of 200 target banks; interview guide; capstone product additions (monthly report, `?demo` mode, CLAUDE.md)	PM, GTM, TECH	Target list v1; **monthly report shipped**; reviewer demo link shared
W2–3 · 19 Oct to 1 Nov	15 to 20 interviews with nodal officers and CEOs; product demos; pricing survey; first federation meetings	PM, CX, GTM	Interview synthesis; persona v2
W4 · 2 to 8 Nov	Finalise positioning, messaging and pricing; spec the pilot additions (SMS/email notifications, CAPTCHA, staff MFA, Hindi and Marathi chat, per-bank escalation matrix)	PMM, PM	**M1: Messaging, pricing and pilot spec locked**
W5–6 · 9 to 22 Nov	Add Hindi and Marathi to the AI Complaint Assistant; build notifications; sign 3 pilot banks (MoU, NDA, data processing agreement); draft security and DPDP pack; finalise capstone package and deck	TECH, GTM, CX, PMM	**M2: 3 pilot banks signed**
W7–8 · 23 Nov to 6 Dec	**Capstone submission and class presentation (25 Nov)**; configure each bank's routing teams and escalation matrix; extend the monthly report into an RBI-format board pack; set up branded instances; train pilot staff; print customer launch kits	TECH, CX, PMM	Pilot instances ready
W9–10 · 7 to 20 Dec	Pilots go live; record baseline (complaints past 24 hours and past 30 days, channels used); weekly check-ins; fix issues	CX, TECH, PM	**M3: Pilots live**
W11–12 · 21 Dec to 3 Jan	Website with sandbox; 3-minute demo video; checklist; sales deck; ROI one-pager; sign vendor and auditor partners	PMM, GTM	Launch assets v1; 2 partners signed
W13–14 · 4 to 17 Jan	Mid-pilot review; capture testimonials; teaser campaign; webinar registrations; press kit; go/no-go review	PM, PMM, CX	**M4: Launch readiness (go/no-go)**

W15 · 18 to 24 Jan	**PUBLIC LAUNCH:** federation co-hosted webinar, press release, founder post, ABM blitz to 200 banks, founding-bank offer	All	**M5: Launch** (150+ registrants; 20 demo requests)
W16–19 · 25 Jan to 21 Feb	Pilots end (60 days); convert to paid; 20+ demos; case study #1; first federation workshop	GTM, CX, PMM	**M6: First paying bank**
W20–24 · 22 Feb to 31 Mar	Conference or roundtable; case study #2; partner-sourced deals; funnel review; refine pricing and target segment; plan next quarter	All	**M7: 2+ paying banks, ₹6 lakh+ contracted ARR, 20-bank pipeline**

9.2 Timeline view

Workstream	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
Capstone product additions	■ done					
Customer discovery	■■■	■				
Positioning, messaging, pricing	■	■■			■ refine	■ refine
Pilot build (notifications, languages, AI tuning)		■■■	■■			
Pilot banks		sign	■■■	■■■	convert	
Partners (federations, vendors, auditors)	■	■■	■■	■■	■■	■■
Content and launch assets		■	■■■	■■	■	■
Public launch				★ 18 Jan		
Sales and ABM	■	■■	■	■■■	■■■	■■■

9.3 RACI for key deliverables

Deliverable	PM	PMM	GTM	TECH	CX
Persona and messaging	A	R	C	I	C
Pricing and packaging	A/R	C	C	C	I
Pilot build (notifications, languages, MFA, AI tuning)	A	I	I	R	C
Pilot banks and onboarding	C	I	A	C	R
Security, DPDP and RBI compliance pack	A	I	C	R	R
Website, content and launch campaign	C	A/R	C	C	I
Federation and vendor partnerships	C	C	A/R	I	I

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

10. Success Metrics, Budget and Risks

10.1 KPIs (to 31 March 2027)

Stage	Metric	Target
Awareness	LinkedIn impressions; website visits; webinar and workshop attendees	150k; 4,000; 300
Acquisition	Qualified leads; demos held	60; 40
Activation	Pilots started; pilot-to-paid conversion	5; ≥ 50%
Revenue	Paying banks; contracted ARR	2+; ₹6 lakh+
Product value (pilot banks)	Open complaints past 30 days; complaints resolved within 24 hours; share lodged online; "where is my complaint" calls; confidential details blocked	0; ≥ 70%; ≥ 60%; −40%; 100% (tracked per bank)
Adoption and advocacy	Weekly active officers; customer satisfaction after resolution; NPS of bank staff; referenceable banks	≥ 80%; ≥ 4/5; ≥ 40; 2

10.2 Indicative launch budget (Oct 2026 to Mar 2027)

Item	Amount (₹)
Events, federation workshops and travel	2,50,000
LinkedIn ads and ABM	1,50,000
Content: demo video, website, checklist and report design	1,25,000
Customer launch kits for pilot banks (posters, inserts, translations)	60,000
Infrastructure and tools (hosting, AI API, SMS, CRM, webinar platform)	75,000
Legal review (DPDP, data processing agreement, privacy notice)	75,000
Contingency (10%)	73,500
Total	**8,08,500**

10.3 Key risks and mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Cooperative banks are conservative and slow, and need board approval	High	Federation endorsement; free pilot; board-note template; peer references
Vendor-risk and IT outsourcing reviews	High	Security pack prepared in advance; India hosting; row-level security; data processing agreement; plan for a third-party security audit
Customers keep using branches and phone	Medium	Customer launch kit with QR codes; branch staff lodge complaints for walk-in customers on the same form, so every complaint is recorded
AI routes a case wrongly or the chatbot misunderstands a customer	Medium	Officers can re-route with one click (corrections improve the model); rule-based fraud flags and the time-based escalation rules still apply even if the AI fails; the chatbot shows a summary for the customer to confirm, and the classic form is always available

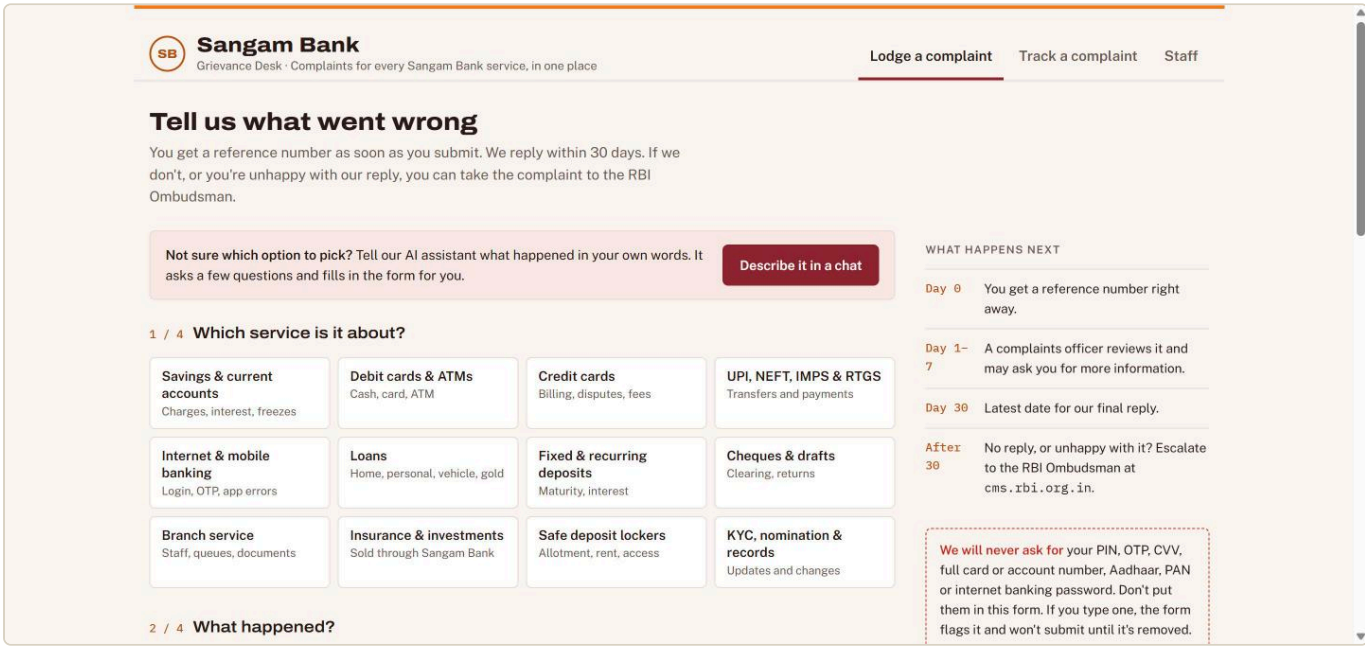
Core-banking vendors build their own version	Medium	Partner with them instead (revenue share); keep a lead on privacy controls and the customer-facing experience
DPDP and RBI rules change	Low–medium	Compliance lead monitors circulars; rules live in the database layer so changes can be made quickly

10.4 Beyond launch

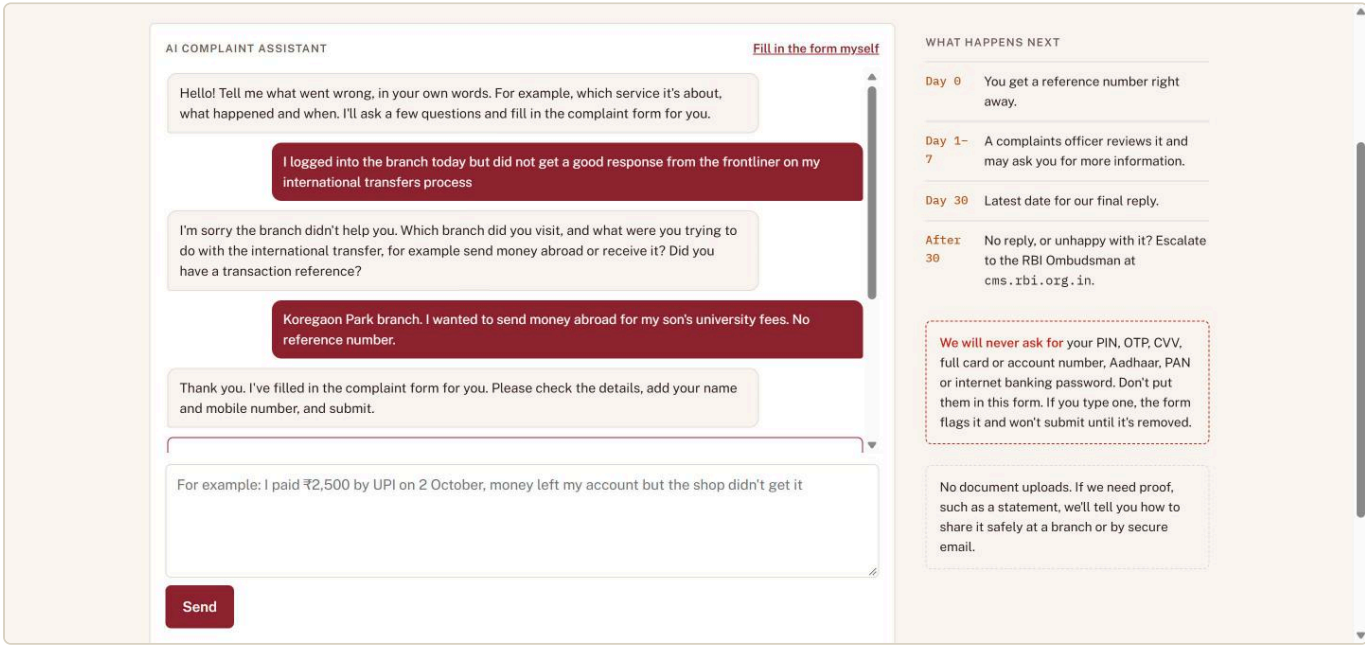
- Product: AI-drafted replies (passed through the confidential-data guard), a weekly AI insight brief for the board built on the monthly report, regional-language forms, WhatsApp intake, predictive scoring of cases likely to breach the 30-day deadline, RBI-format disclosure reports.
- Markets: NBFCs and digital lenders (Year 2), insurance (IRDAI's Bima Bharosa flow) and brokers (SEBI SCORES), then other markets with regulator-led grievance rules.

Appendix A. Product Walkthrough

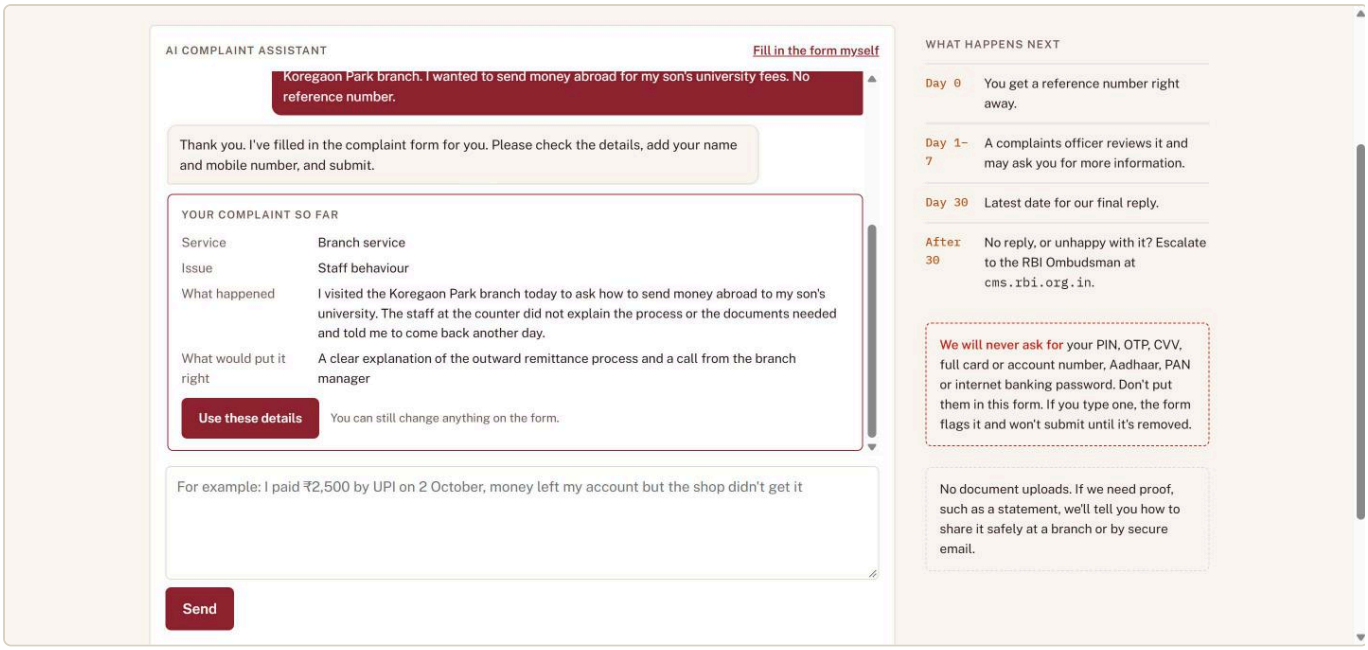
Screenshots of the working product, live at **https://connect2soniasuresh-ui.github.io/MyComplaintsSystem/**. Complaint data is sample data. The chat conversation and staff views were captured in the product's demo mode, which runs the same screens without the live database.



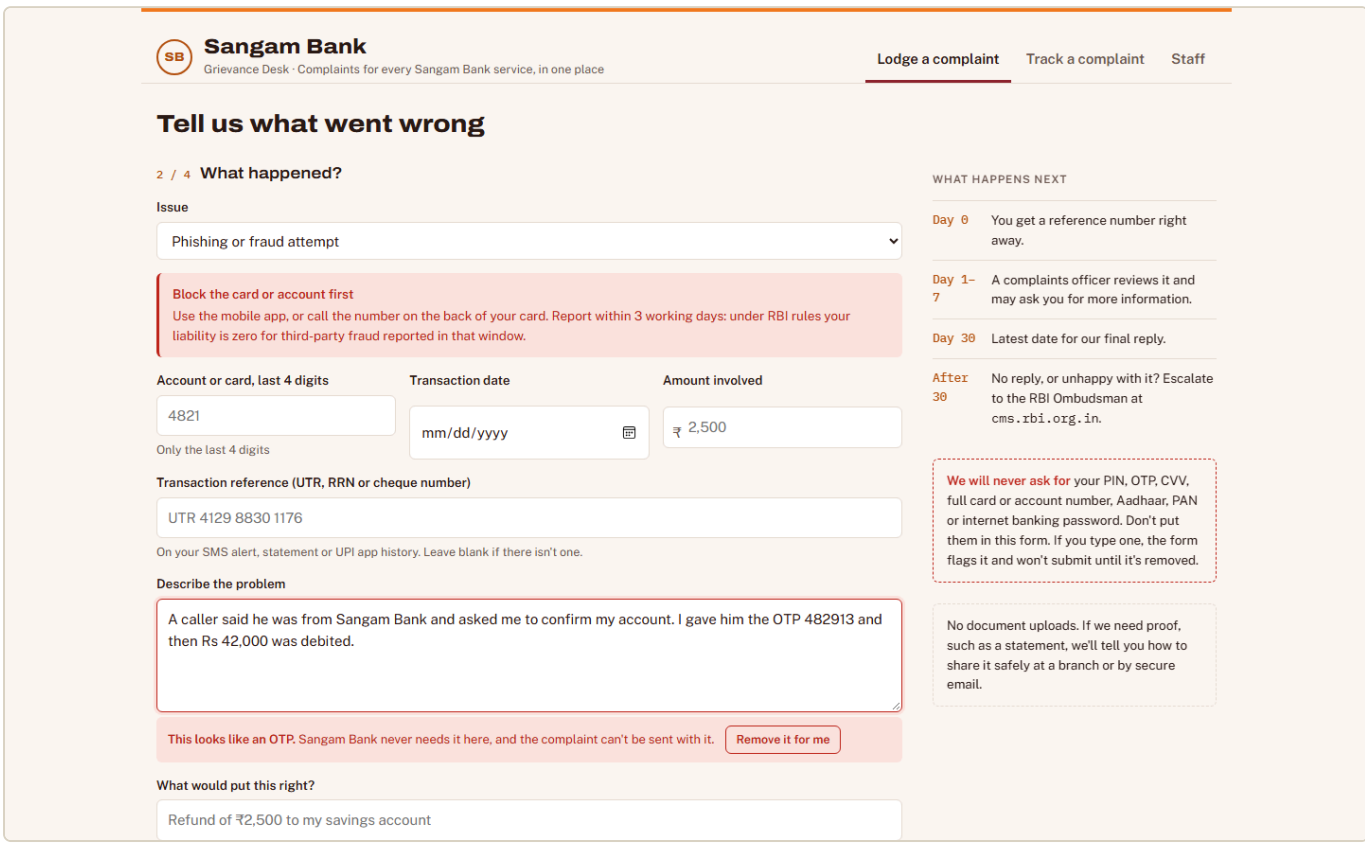
A1. Lodge tab: the AI assistant entry point above the guided 12-service form, with the “what happens next” timeline and the “we will never ask for” promise.



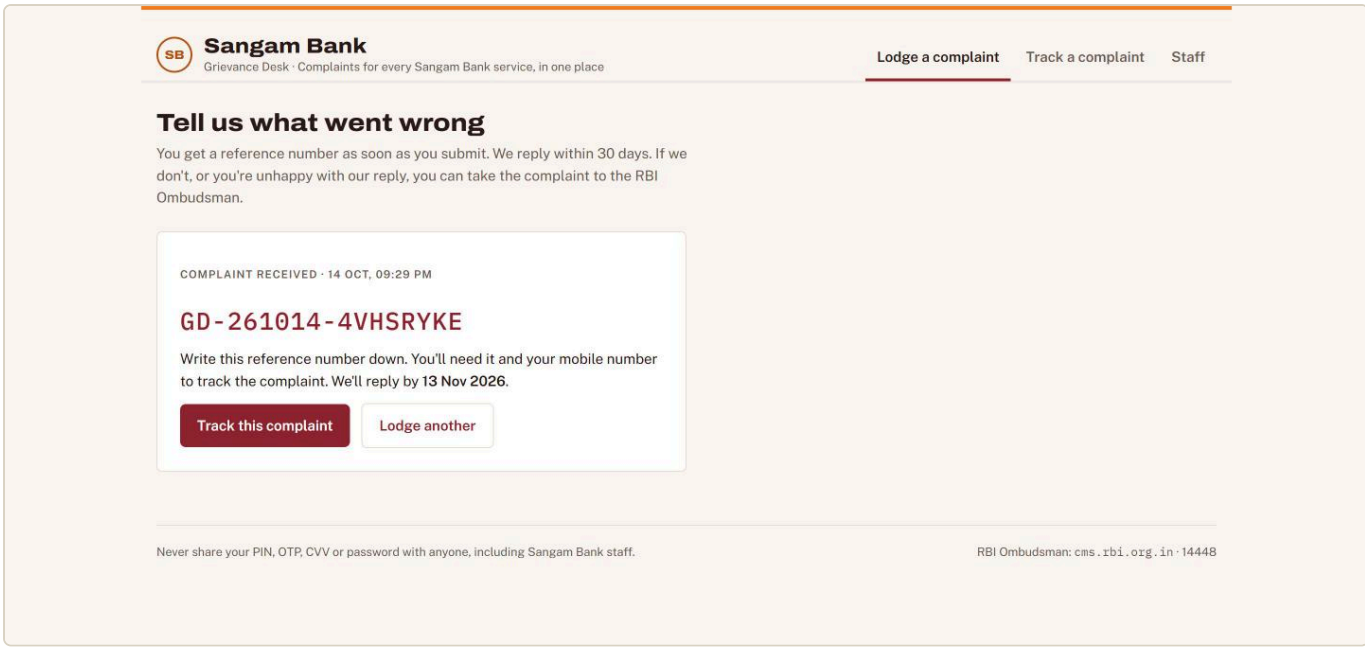
A2. AI Complaint Assistant: the customer describes the problem in their own words and the assistant asks only what's missing.



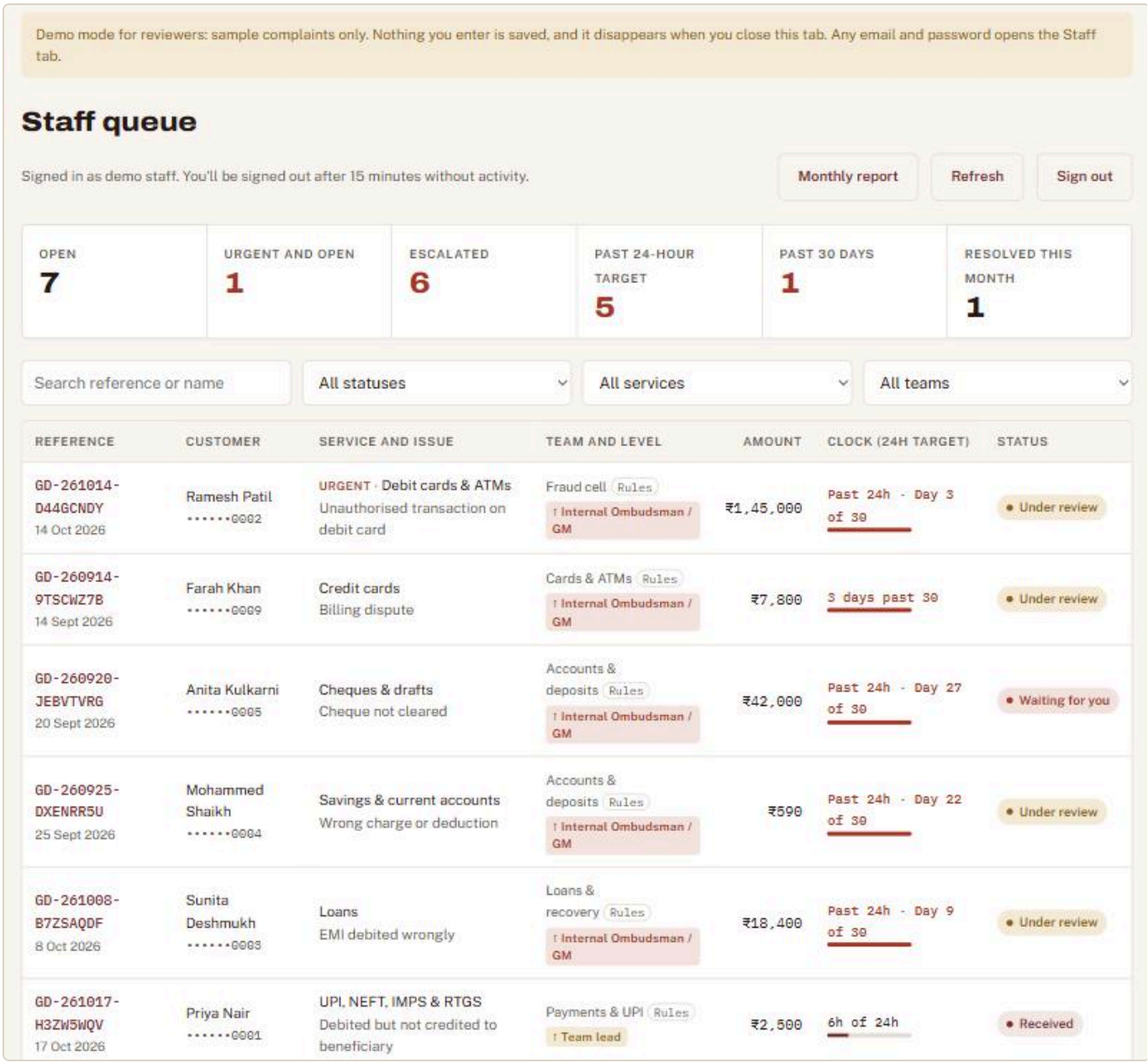
A3. The assistant's draft: service, issue and a clear description, ready to fill in the form with one click. The customer still adds their own contact details and submits.



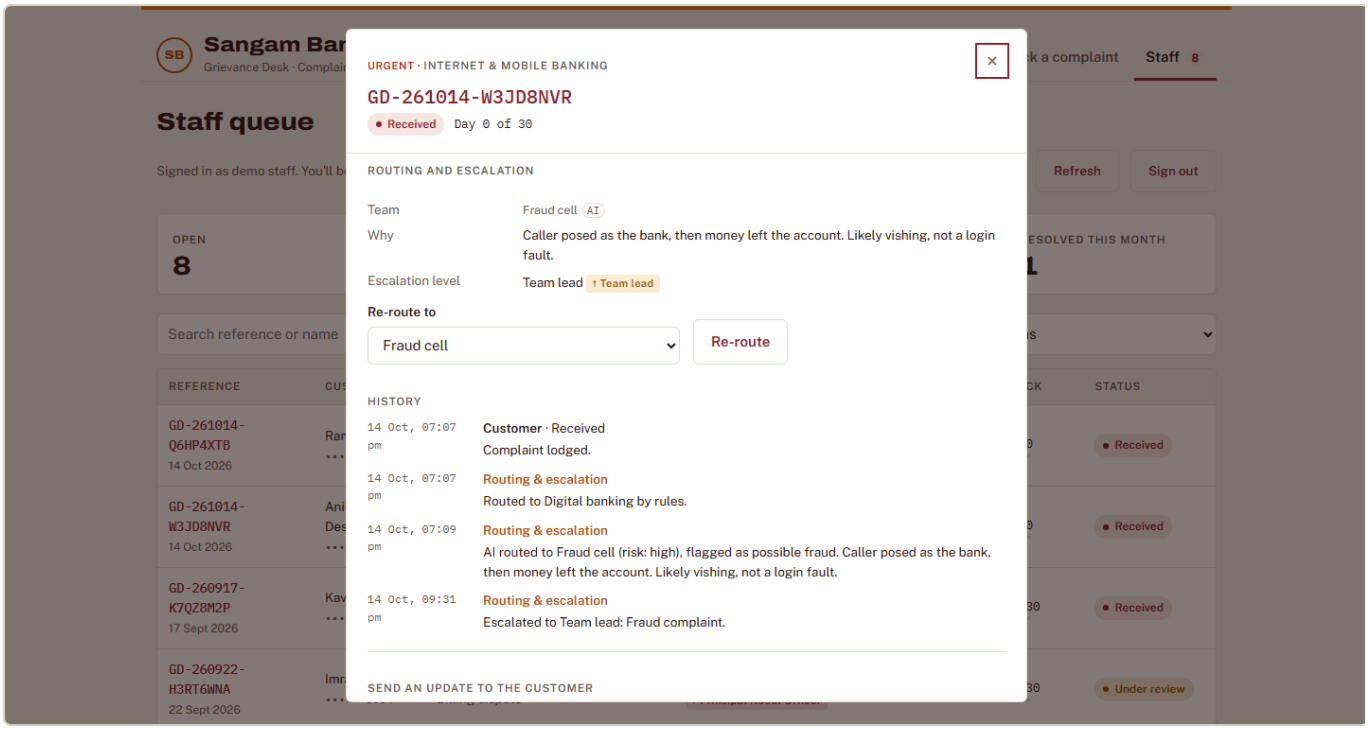
A4. Safe by design: an OTP typed into the description is flagged and the complaint can't be sent until it's removed. The same check runs again in the database. The fraud issue also shows block-first guidance.



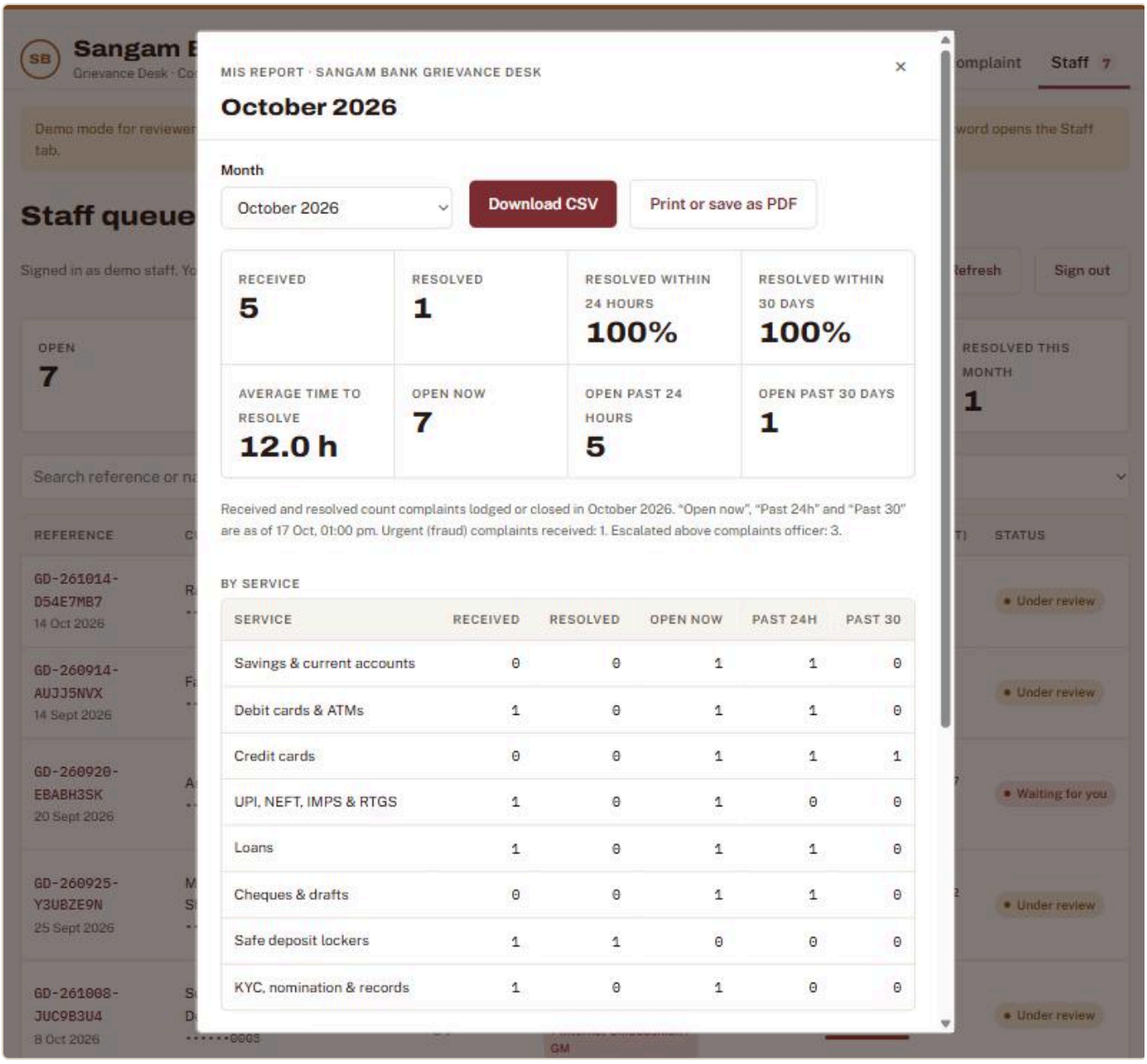
A5. Instant reference number and the reply-by date (Day 30).



A6. Staff queue: Past 24-hour target and Escalated tiles, team and escalation level on every case, 24-hour clock, urgent and escalated cases first.



A7. Case detail: a complaint filed as a login problem, re-routed by AI to the Fraud cell (risk: high) with its reason, escalated to the team lead, with the full routing history and a one-click re-route.



A8. New for the capstone: the monthly report, with CSV download and print to PDF.

Try it

What to try	How
Lodge with the AI assistant	Lodge tab → "Describe it in a chat". Try typing an OTP to see it blocked.
Lodge with the form	Pick a service and issue, describe the problem, add name and mobile, submit.
Track a complaint	Track tab → reference number and the mobile number used when lodging.
Staff queue, routing and escalation	Open the live address with `?demo`, then Staff tab → any email and password. 9 sample complaints show every escalation rule. On the live database, staff accounts are available from the team on request.
Monthly report	Staff tab → "Monthly report" → switch months, "Download CSV", "Print or save as PDF".

Appendix B. Sources

1. Reserve Bank of India, *Annual Report of the Ombudsman Scheme 2024-25* (rbi.org.in, publication id 23441), as reported by Outlook Money, CAalley and AffairsCloud, December 2025.
2. Reserve Bank of India, *Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India 2024-25* (rbi.org.in, publication id 23640); Business Standard, "Number of UCBs declines to 1,457 in FY25", December 2025.
3. Indian Cooperative, "UCBs see decline in complaints: RBI releases Report": complaints against UCBs and the ₹50 crore coverage threshold.
4. Reserve Bank of India, *Annual Report 2024-25*, fraud statistics, as reported by Deccan Chronicle, May 2025.
5. Ministry of Finance, amalgamation of Regional Rural Banks effective 1 May 2025, as reported by Business Standard and The Week.
6. National Statistics Office, *Comprehensive Annual Modular Survey 2022-23*.
7. Reserve Bank of India, *Integrated Ombudsman Scheme, 2021*; directions on limiting customer liability in unauthorised electronic banking transactions; Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

Market sizes, prices and unit economics are planning estimates by Group 5 and will be refined after customer interviews and pilots. Some figures come from press reports of RBI publications and should be checked against the originals before external use.

Prepared by Group 5 for the Capstone Project, Product Management with AI, IIM Calcutta.